

Internal Working

When MySQL renames a table, it does not copy all the data. Instead, it updates the metadata (data dictionary) so that the table has a new name. This is why renaming is generally much faster than recreating a table and copying data.

Example

```
RENAME TABLE Student TO Students;
```

Internal Working

MySQL:

- checks permissions,
- verifies the new name doesn't already exist,
- updates metadata,
- releases locks.

No row data is modified.

ALTER TABLE ... RENAME

Another way.

Syntax

```
ALTER TABLE Student  
RENAME TO Students;
```

Rename Columns

```
ALTER TABLE Student  
RENAME COLUMN Name TO FullName;
```

Older syntax

```
ALTER TABLE Student  
CHANGE COLUMN Name  
FullName VARCHAR(100);
```

How to Rename a Database

MySQL does not support RENAME DATABASE.
because it could lead to corruption and other issues.

The typical process is:

- Create new database
- Move tables
(using tools like mysqldump)
- Verify data
- Drop old database

```
DROP DATABASE College;
```

Renaming an Index

Modern MySQL supports:

```
ALTER TABLE Student  
RENAME INDEX idx_old TO idx_new;
```